

3810. Minimum Operations to Reach Target Array

Solved ●

Medium   Hint

You are given two integer arrays `nums` and `target`, each of length `n`, where `nums[i]` is the current value at index `i` and `target[i]` is the desired value at index `i`.

You may perform the following operation any number of times (including zero):

- Choose an integer value `x`.
- Find all **maximal contiguous segments** where `nums[i] == x` (a segment is **maximal** if it cannot be extended to the left or right while keeping all values equal to `x`).
- For each such segment `[l, r]`, update **simultaneously**:
 - `nums[l] = target[l]`, `nums[l + 1] = target[l + 1]`, ..., `nums[r] = target[r]`

Return the **minimum** number of operations required to make `nums` equal to `target`.

Example 1:

Input: `nums = [1,2,3]`, `target = [2,1,3]`

Output: 2

Explanation:

- Choose `x = 1`: maximal segment `[0, 0]` updated -> `nums` becomes `[2, 2, 3]`
- Choose `x = 2`: maximal segment `[0, 1]` updated (`nums[0]` stays 2, `nums[1]` becomes 1) -> `nums` becomes `[2, 1, 3]`
- Thus, 2 operations are required to convert `nums` to `target`.

Example 2:

Input: `nums = [4,1,4]`, `target = [5,1,4]`

Output: 1

Explanation:

- Choose `x = 4`: maximal segments `[0, 0]` and `[2, 2]` updated (`nums[2]` stays 4) -> `nums` becomes `[5, 1, 4]`
- Thus, 1 operation is required to convert `nums` to `target`.

Example 3:

Input: `nums = [7,3,7]`, `target = [5,5,9]`

Output: 2

Explanation:

- Choose `x = 7`: maximal segments `[0, 0]` and `[2, 2]` updated -> `nums` becomes `[5, 3, 9]`
- Choose `x = 3`: maximal segment `[1, 1]` updated -> `nums` becomes `[5, 5, 9]`
- Thus, 2 operations are required to convert `nums` to `target`.

Constraints:

- `1 <= n == nums.length == target.length <= 105`
- `1 <= nums[i], target[i] <= 105`

Seen this question in a real interview before? 1/5

Yes No

Accepted 23,234/37.2K | Acceptance Rate 62.5%

Topics



Hint 1



Hint 2



Discussion (43)



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